

NORTHSTAR OUTFITTERS

Shipping, Delivery & Order Tracking Guide

Processing times, delivery estimates, tracking, address changes, split shipments, and delivery exceptions

CUSTOMER SAFE

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Purpose	Customer-facing reference for explaining shipping expectations and safe troubleshooting paths.

Demo environment only. Northstar Outfitters, its customers, products, prices, orders, and commercial terms are fictional and created for SupportOps demonstrations.

Document Control

Audience	Customers and Support
Scope	Order processing, shipping methods, estimates, tracking events, address changes, delivery exceptions, and customs
Authority	Authoritative for policy and expected process. Current order, fulfillment, tracking, and purchasability state must come from Shopify/approved operational systems.
Review cycle	Quarterly or after a material policy/commerce change
Change control	Material changes require owner review and publication before becoming authoritative knowledge.
Knowledge governance Only documents marked PUBLISHED in SupportOps are authoritative for customer-facing answers. Current Shopify catalog, variant, price, availability, cart, and authenticated order state should be obtained from the approved Shopify MCP capability rather than inferred from static documentation.	

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1. Order Lifecycle

A typical Northstar order moves through order confirmation, processing, fulfillment, carrier handoff, transit, and delivery. Customers may see different statuses depending on whether an order has one or multiple fulfillments.

Stage	Meaning	Customer expectation
Order confirmed	Order accepted by store	Confirmation is not the same as carrier pickup.
Processing	Warehouse is preparing items	Changes may still be possible but are not guaranteed.
Fulfilled	Shipment has been prepared/handed off	Tracking may take time to receive first scan.
In transit	Carrier has movement events	Delivery estimate can change with carrier events.
Delivered	Carrier reports delivery	Use delivered-but-missing steps if parcel cannot be located.

2. Processing Time

Standard processing target is 1-2 business days for in-stock items. High-volume periods, address review, payment review, or split inventory can extend processing. Processing time is separate from carrier transit time.

Estimate, not guarantee

Processing and delivery windows are service targets. A customer-specific promise should not be made unless the live order/carrier system provides a guaranteed service commitment.

3. Shipping Regions

Destination group	Standard service target	Express service target	Notes
Singapore	2-4 business days	1-2 business days	After processing
Indonesia & Malaysia	4-8 business days	2-5 business days	Customs/last-mile variation possible
Thailand & Philippines	5-10 business days	3-6 business days	Remote areas may require more time
Other supported markets	Shown at checkout	Shown at checkout	Use checkout as authoritative availability

Shipping methods actually available to a customer depend on destination, cart contents, market rules, and carrier configuration. Checkout is authoritative for method availability and final shipping price.

4. Delivery Estimates

1. Start with current order/fulfillment status.
2. Identify carrier and latest tracking event if fulfilled.
3. Use policy windows to explain what is normal.
4. Do not calculate a guaranteed arrival date from policy alone.
5. If a requested deadline is critical, clearly distinguish estimate from guarantee.

5. Order Cutoff and Weekends

Orders placed before 13:00 Singapore Time on business days are generally eligible to begin processing the same business day, but warehouse workload and review can shift processing. Orders placed after cutoff, on weekends, or on public holidays typically begin processing on the next business day.

6. Tracking

Tracking state	Interpretation	Recommended response
Label created	Shipment prepared; carrier may not have scanned it yet	Allow normal first-scan window.
In transit	Carrier is moving parcel	Use carrier estimate and latest event.
Exception	Carrier reports disruption	Explain event; escalate if action is required.
Out for delivery	Final-mile delivery expected	Advise customer to monitor delivery location.
Delivered	Carrier reports completion	Use missing-delivery checklist if customer cannot locate parcel.

6.1 No first scan

A label-created event without movement for less than one business day can be normal. If no movement persists beyond two business days after fulfillment, Support should verify handoff status and consider carrier/fulfillment escalation.

7. Split Shipments

An order may be split when items are stored in different locations or become ready at different times. Each fulfillment can have its own tracking number. A partial shipment does not automatically mean the remaining item was cancelled.

- Confirm all fulfillments before telling the customer an item is missing.
- Explain each tracking number separately.
- If one item has no fulfillment and processing exceeds the normal window, escalate the unfulfilled line item.

8. Address Changes

Order state	Address-change handling
Not fulfilled	Support may attempt an address correction if operational controls allow; success is not guaranteed.
Fulfillment in progress	Change may no longer be possible; escalate if the system permits intervention.
Carrier accepted	Northstar generally cannot guarantee rerouting; carrier options may apply.
Delivered	Address change is no longer applicable; use delivery investigation process.

Security rule

Never change an order address based only on an unverified message containing a new address. Follow customer verification controls for account/order changes.

9. Delayed Shipments

Condition	Normal handling	Escalate when
Within published transit window	Set expectation and share current tracking	Carrier event indicates exception requiring action
Past estimated delivery by 1 business day	Check latest event and allow short carrier variance	No movement or customer has urgent documented need
No movement 3+ business days	Open carrier investigation path	Immediately
International customs hold	Explain customs can add time	Carrier/customs requests merchant documentation or hold is prolonged

10. Delivered but Missing

6. Confirm delivery address and carrier-delivered timestamp.
7. Ask customer to check household members, reception, parcel lockers, safe places, and immediate neighbors where appropriate.
8. Review proof-of-delivery information if available.
9. If still missing after reasonable local checks, begin the delivery investigation process.
10. Do not accuse the customer or guarantee an immediate refund before investigation.

11. Damaged Parcels

Customers should retain packaging and photograph visible damage where practical. Product damage and packaging-only damage are different. Product damage should be handled under the return/refund policy and internal exception workflow.

12. International Duties and Customs

Taxes, duties, and import handling can depend on destination and market configuration. Checkout and local import rules determine the customer's actual charges. Support should not provide legal or tax advice. If a shipment is held because merchant documentation is required, route to fulfillment operations.

13. Cancellation Before Fulfillment

Cancellation may be possible before fulfillment begins, but it is not guaranteed because warehouse processing can move quickly. Once an order has been fulfilled, the normal return process generally applies instead of cancellation.

14. Support Decision Matrix

Question	Primary live source	Knowledge use	Escalation trigger
Where is my order?	Shopify order/fulfillment + tracking	Explain status and normal window	No movement beyond threshold
Can I change address?	Current fulfillment state	Explain state-based policy	Change requires internal intervention
Why did only one item arrive?	All fulfillments	Explain split shipments	Remaining line exceeds processing window
Can it arrive by Friday?	Carrier/checkout estimate	Explain estimate vs guarantee	Only if service failure/urgent exception
Tracking says delivered but I have nothing	Tracking/POD	Missing-delivery checklist	Parcel remains missing after checks

15. FAQ

Q. Does express shipping skip processing time?

A. No. Express generally affects carrier transit, not necessarily warehouse processing.

Q. Can Support promise a delivery date?

A. Only when an authoritative service provides a guarantee. Otherwise communicate the current estimate.

Q. Why do I have two tracking numbers?

A. The order may have been split into multiple fulfillments.

Q. Can I cancel after a tracking number exists?

A. Once fulfillment has progressed, cancellation may no longer be possible; use the return process after delivery if needed.

Q. Who pays duties?

A. The applicable checkout/market terms and destination rules control the answer; Support should not guess.

Appendix A - Carrier Event Glossary

Event	What it usually means	What it does not prove
Shipment information received	Carrier has electronic shipment data	Carrier physically possesses parcel
Picked up / accepted	Carrier has accepted parcel	Parcel will arrive on original estimate without delay
Departed facility	Parcel left a carrier node	Next scan will occur immediately
Customs processing	Shipment is in customs workflow	Customer owes a specific amount unless officially assessed
Delivery attempted	Carrier attempted final-mile delivery	Customer intentionally refused delivery
Delivered	Carrier marked shipment delivered	Customer physically located parcel

Appendix B - Timing Examples

Order example	Processing interpretation	Delivery communication
Mon 10:00 SGT, Singapore standard	Eligible to begin same-day processing; 1-2 business-day processing target	Then standard carrier estimate 2-4 business days
Fri 18:00 SGT, Indonesia express	After cutoff; processing typically begins next business day	Express transit estimate starts after fulfillment/carrier handoff
Public holiday order	Warehouse start can shift to next business day	Do not count holiday as normal processing day
Split inventory order	Different lines may fulfill separately	Explain multiple tracking numbers and separate estimates

Appendix C - Missing Delivery Investigation Checklist

11. Verify the address on the order without exposing unnecessary personal data.
12. Verify delivered timestamp, carrier, and any delivery proof available.
13. Ask the customer to check safe-place/reception/household/parcel locker locations.
14. Check whether another fulfillment/tracking number exists.
15. Record whether the customer confirms the parcel remains missing.
16. Escalate to the approved carrier/loss workflow when local checks are exhausted.

Appendix D - Address Modification Examples

Situation	Recommended handling
Typo noticed minutes after order; unfulfilled	Verify customer and attempt approved change; do not guarantee until confirmed
Customer wants different country after fulfillment	Do not promise reroute; explain shipment is already progressing
Customer asks to redirect to hotel while in transit	Use only supported carrier/intercept paths; assess verification/risk
Unverified person requests address change	Do not act; verification required

Appendix E - Peak-Period Operations

During major campaigns or holiday peaks, processing estimates can be temporarily extended. Any temporary customer-facing notice published by Northstar becomes the applicable expectation for the stated period. Agents should not rely on an expired peak notice after it has been withdrawn.

- Check for active service notices before declaring a shipment late.
- Separate warehouse delay from carrier delay.
- Avoid issuing duplicate replacements before loss is reasonably established.

- When many customers show the same delay pattern, escalate as a potential incident rather than isolated tickets.

Appendix F - Service Exception Communication

When Northstar publishes a temporary service notice for weather, carrier disruption, warehouse maintenance, or campaign volume, the notice should be used only for the stated dates/regions. It supplements this guide rather than permanently changing the baseline policy.

Situation	Customer-safe communication
Severe weather impacts lane	Your shipment may take longer than the normal estimate because the carrier has reported weather-related disruption in the route.
Warehouse campaign backlog	We are currently processing higher-than-normal order volume. Your order is still active; the latest order status is the best indicator of progress.
Carrier service suspension	That shipping service is temporarily unavailable for the destination. Checkout will show currently available alternatives.
Customs documentation required	The shipment is waiting on a customs/merchant documentation step. Our fulfillment team is reviewing it; avoid promising a release date until confirmed.

Appendix G - Tracking Conversation Checklist

17. Confirm order and fulfillment identity.
18. State the latest tracking event and timestamp.
19. Compare it with the normal processing/transit window.
20. Explain whether the situation is still within expectation or has crossed an escalation threshold.
21. Give the customer one clear next step and when they should expect another update.
22. Avoid repeatedly telling the customer to “wait” without a defined reason or threshold.